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POP Shop Fulfillment Assignment

Task 1: Picking the Problem

The support data gives us three buckets: WISMO at 34%, return/refund status at 28%, and wrong item or damaged delivery at 12%. The obvious move is to pick WISMO because it is the biggest number. But I wanted to check if this actually matches what real users are saying.

I went through around 70 recent Play Store reviews for POP. Most of them were 1-star. The complaints covered the late deliveries, refunds stuck for weeks, returns getting rejected, orders going missing. But the pattern I noticed was that almost every review, regardless of the actual issue, had the same underlying frustration: the user had no visibility into what was happening and POP was not communicating anything.

Some common things I saw in the reviews:

- Orders marked undelivered without any delivery attempt or call to the customer
- Refunds pending for weeks with no timeline given by support
- Support sending the same copy-paste reply every time without actually solving anything
- No updates at all when an order was delayed or stuck

Before building, I would check three things

- **Are users complaining before the delay even happens** I would check when WISMO tickets are being raised compared to the expected delivery date. If a lot of them are coming in before the delivery window has even passed, it means users do not trust POP to begin with. The problem is not the delay, it is the lack of confidence.
- **Are users checking the tracking page multiple times before calling support** If someone is opening the tracking page 3 or 4 times and still ending up calling support, it means the tracking page is not answering their question. It is giving them nothing useful.
- **Do these users come back and order again** I would compare repeat orders between two groups: users who raised a WISMO ticket, and users who had a delayed order but never complained. If there is a big gap between the two, it means the support experience itself is what is driving users away, not just the delay.

I am picking WISMO, Not just because it is the biggest number, but because this is where the problem starts. Once a user contacts support about a delay and gets no real answer, they stop trusting POP. By the time they need a return or a refund, they are already fed up. Fix this first and the rest becomes easier.

When would I change my pick: If sending proactive updates to users does not reduce the number of complaints, then communication is not the real problem. In that case I would shift focus to the delivery partners and why orders are actually getting delayed.

Task 2: Scenario A - Solution Proposed Delayed Order, No Communication

I picked this scenario because if the user does not even know where their order is, nothing else matters. You cannot talk about returns or refunds when the person is still waiting for the order to show up. So fixing communication here is the first step, everything else comes after.

What is happening today vs what should happen

- **Today:** Order gets delayed. POP does not say anything. User opens the app, sees the same Ordered and Shipped steps with no movement. They tap Track Order and get a red banner saying Tracker not available at this moment. So they contact support. Support sends a copy paste reply. User is now frustrated.
- **What should happen:** Order gets delayed. POP detects it on its own and messages the user first. User already know what is going on before they even open the app.

When should the notification go out

The message goes out only when all three of these are true at the same time:

1. The order has not been delivered even after 4 hours past the promised date
2. The courier has not scanned or moved the package in the last 6 hours
3. POP has not already sent a delay message for this order before

Why wait 4 hours and not send immediately : Most delivery partners in India do two rounds in a day, one in the morning and one in the evening. So if someone is supposed to get the order by afternoon and it does not come, there is a good chance it is coming in the evening round. If we send a panic message at hour one, we are worrying the user for no reason. Waiting 4 hours means we only alert when it is actually looking like a real delay. I would test 4 hours vs 6 hours vs 8 hours in the first week to see which one results in fewer support calls.

What the user sees

Push notification: Something simple and direct like:

Hi Adarsh, your order is running a bit late. New expected delivery: tomorrow by 8 PM. We will keep you updated.

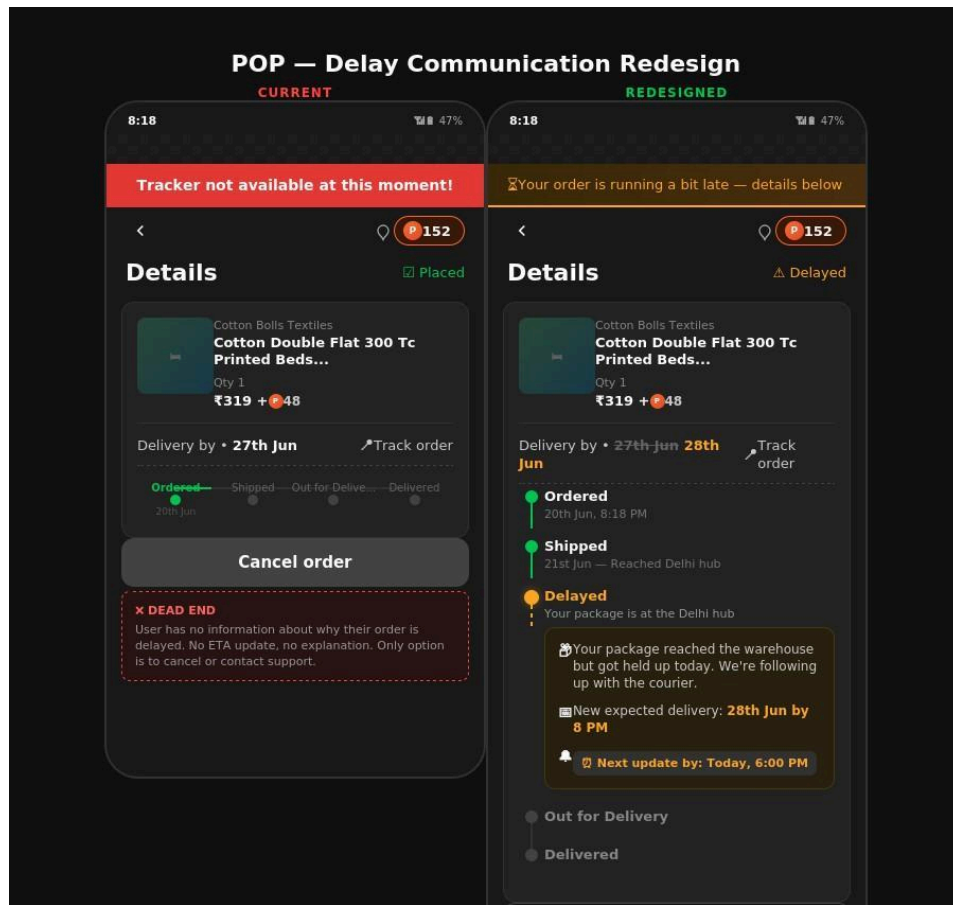
What changes on the tracking page:

Right now the POP app shows four steps: Ordered, Shipped, Out for Delivery, and Delivered. When someone taps Track Order during a delay, they currently see a red error that says Tracker is not available at this moment. This is the worst possible thing to show someone who is already anxious about their order.

Here is what I would change:

- Add a fifth status between Shipped and Out for Delivery called Delayed. This way the user can see something has changed and POP is aware of it
- Below the status, show a short line in plain words like: Your order is taking a little longer than expected. We are following up with the courier
- Show a Next update by: 6 PM today line so the user has a reason to wait instead of calling support

- If we say 6 PM, we send an update at 6 PM. Even if it is just saying still delayed, we follow through

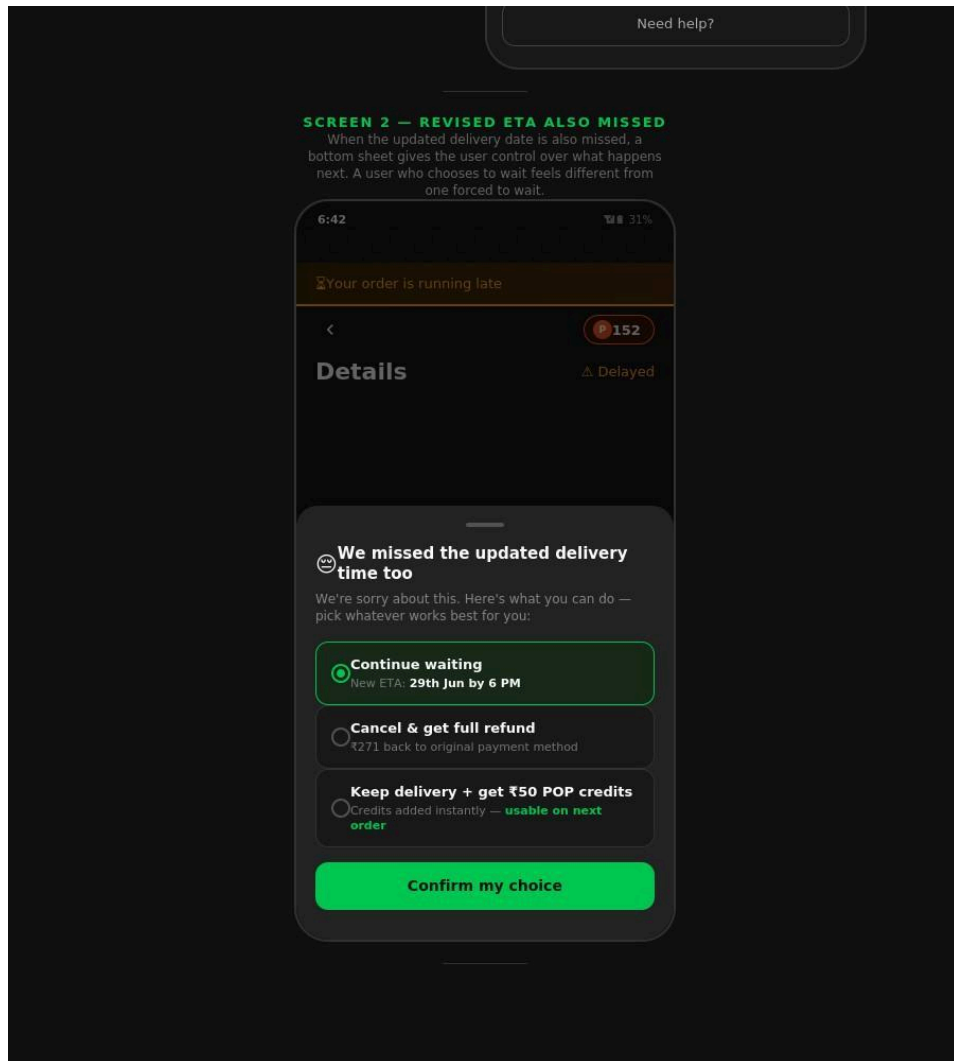


If the revised ETA is also missed

Second notification goes out with clear options:

1. Continue waiting with a new ETA
2. Cancel the order and get a full refund
3. Keep the delivery and get Rs.50 POP credits for the inconvenience

A user who chooses to wait feels very different from one who is forced to wait with no information. The credits option keeps the order alive without needing a full refund.



Edge cases

- **What if we have no delivery update at all** Sometimes the courier system itself stops sharing any information for 12+ hours. In that case we should not send any message to the user until our internal team has checked what is actually happening. Sending wrong information is worse than sending nothing.
- **What if we miss the new delivery date** Also, if we give the user a new expected date and that also gets missed, the user should be connected to a real support person, not get another automated message. At this point the cancel and refund option should be clearly visible, not buried.
- **How many delay messages is too many** We should not send more than 3 delay updates for the same order. After the third message, if the order is still not delivered, a real support person should reach out. Nobody wants to keep getting we are working on it messages with no resolution.

What I would not build yet

- **Live courier map:** Needs real time GPS from carrier partners. In India this data is unreliable. If the map shows the courier is 2 km away when they are at a different hub, it destroys trust faster than having no map. Revisit when GPS reliability crosses 95%.

- **Auto-compensation for every delay:** If every late order gets credits automatically, users learn that delays equal free money. That changes behaviour and can be gamed. Keep compensation for repeated failures only.
- **ML-based ETA prediction:** We do not have clean route-level or pincode level data to train on right now. Building better communication first will actually generate the structured data needed for ML later.

Task 3: Where AI Helps vs Where It Hurts

Where AI genuinely helps

When your order is out for delivery, the delivery company like Delhivery or Shadowfax keeps updating their own internal system with status codes. These are written for their warehouse staff, not for customers. So they say things like FM attempt failed or Shipment exception, hub sorting delay. Nobody outside the delivery company knows what this means.

Right now most apps do one of two things: they either show this confusing text directly to the user, or they just hide it and show In Transit which tells the user nothing. Both options leave the user in the dark.

This is where AI can actually help. The AI reads the delivery company's internal update and automatically rewrites it in simple words before showing it to the user. The user never sees the confusing code, they only see a message they can understand.

For example:

- **What the delivery system says:** Shipment exception, hub sorting delay
What the user sees: Your package reached the warehouse but got held up today. It should move in the next 12 to 24 hours.
- **What the delivery system says:** FM attempt failed, customer unavailable
What the user sees: Our delivery partner tried to deliver but could not reach you. They will try again tomorrow. You can also update your available time here.

The important thing is that AI is not making things up here. It is just taking a fixed set of delivery status codes and converting each one into a readable message. It works within a defined set of messages, it does not generate random explanations on its own.

Where AI would make things worse

Now imagine POP decides to go one step further. Instead of just telling the user their order is delayed, the app also tries to explain why it is delayed. So the user sees something like: your order is delayed due to heavy rain in your area, or due to festive season rush.

This sounds helpful but it is actually dangerous. The AI does not actually know why the order is delayed. It is just looking at patterns and making a guess. It has no real information about what is happening with that specific order.

Here is a real example of how this goes wrong: Multiple orders in Bangalore are getting delayed. The AI looks at this and guesses it must be because of rain or bad weather. So it tells users, your order is delayed due to

weather conditions in your area. The user steps outside and it is a completely sunny day. The actual reason was that the delivery company did not have enough staff that day. Now the user knows the app just made something up. Whatever little trust they had left is gone.

The safer approach is to be straightforward. If we do not know why the order is delayed, we should just say that. Something like your order has not moved yet, we are checking with the courier and will update you. That is honest. Users can handle honesty. What they cannot handle is being lied to.

Simple Rule: AI should only tell the user what is happening right now and what will happen next. It should never try to explain why, because it does not actually know why.

Measuring Success

Primary metric: Repeat purchase rate specifically among users who experienced a delivery delay. Not overall repeat rate because too many other things affect it. I want to isolate whether proactive communication changes if delayed-order users come back.

Test setup: Cohorted A/B test. 50% of delayed orders get the new notifications, 50% get the current experience. Measure over 60 days.

Supporting metrics:

- WISMO ticket rate on delayed orders, targeting 25-40% reduction
- Support contact rate within 48 hours of a missed ETA
- CSAT on delayed orders specifically
- Update coverage: what percentage of delayed orders are we catching and notifying, target 85%+ in month one

WISMO is not really a tracking problem. It is the first place where POP's post-order visibility breaks. Fix communication here, and you get both the infrastructure and the customer trust to tackle returns and damaged deliveries next. Start where the trust breaks first.